

Was Jacob buried in the city of Shechem/Sychem or somewhere else?

### Acts 7:15-16

<sup>15</sup> So Jacob went down into Egypt, and died, he, and our fathers,

<sup>16</sup> And were carried over into Sychem<sup>G4966 (H7927)</sup>, and laid in the sepulchre that Abraham bought for a sum of money of the sons of Emmor<sup>G1697 (H2544)</sup> *the father* of Sychem<sup>G4966</sup>.

- The first mention of Sychem (Shechem) here refers to the *country* of which the man Shechem was prince of (Gen 34:2) which included at least the regions which would later be called Jerusalem (Gen 33:18) and Hebron (Gen 23:19, 49:29,30, 50:13).
- We know this isn't referring to the *city* of Shechem because the sepulchre (and field) that Abraham bought from the sons of Emmor (Hamor) is roughly 48.7 miles south/south-west of the city of Shechem in Hebron.
- Jacob, Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Rebekah, and Leah were all buried in that same cave (sepulchre).

### Genesis 23:1-2

<sup>1</sup> And Sarah was an hundred and seven and twenty years old: *these were* the years of the life of Sarah.

<sup>2</sup> And Sarah died in Kirjath-arba; the same *is* Hebron in the land of Canaan: and Abraham came to mourn for Sarah, and to weep for her.

### Genesis 23:17-19

<sup>17</sup> And the field of Ephron, which *was* in Machpelah, which *was* before Mamre, the field, and the cave which *was* therein, and all the trees that *were* in the field, that *were* in all the borders round about, were made sure

<sup>18</sup> Unto Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all that went in at the gate of his city.

<sup>19</sup> And after this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah before Mamre: the same *is* Hebron in the land of Canaan.

- Abraham buys a cave and a field from Ephron the Hittite.
- 37 years after bringing forth Isaac, Sarah dies and is buried in Hebron.

### Genesis 49:29-32 (Jacob speaking to his children)

<sup>29</sup> And he charged them, and said unto them, I am to be gathered unto my people: bury me with my **fathers** in the cave that *is* in the field of Ephron the Hittite,

<sup>30</sup> In the cave that *is* in the field of Machpelah, which *is* before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field of Ephron the Hittite for a possession of a buryingplace.

<sup>31</sup> There they buried Abraham and Sarah his wife; there they buried Isaac and Rebekah his wife; and there I buried Leah.

<sup>32</sup> The purchase of the field and of the cave that *is* therein was from the children of Heth.

### Genesis 50:13

For his sons carried him into the land of Canaan, and buried him in the cave of the field of Machpelah, which Abraham bought with the field for a possession of a buryingplace of Ephron the Hittite, before Mamre.

- After dying in Egypt, Jacob is buried in Hebron in the same cave as Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Rebekah, and Leah.

## Extra notes

That same cave is referred to as being bought *from*:  
“the sons of Emmor/Hamor”  
“the children of Heth”

The field is referred to as:  
“the field of Ephron the Hittite”  
Ephron dwelt among the children of Heth ([Gen 23:10](#)).

Both the field and the cave were the possession of Ephron ([Gen 23:9](#)) and initially Abraham requests only the cave. Ephron offers the field as well as the cave for free ([Gen 23:11](#)). Abraham accepts both the cave and the field offer and pays for both of them. Abraham pays 400 shekels of silver to Ephron the Hittite for the cave and the field ([Gen 23:16](#)).

That means that Ephron the Hittite is a descendant of both Hamor and Heth.